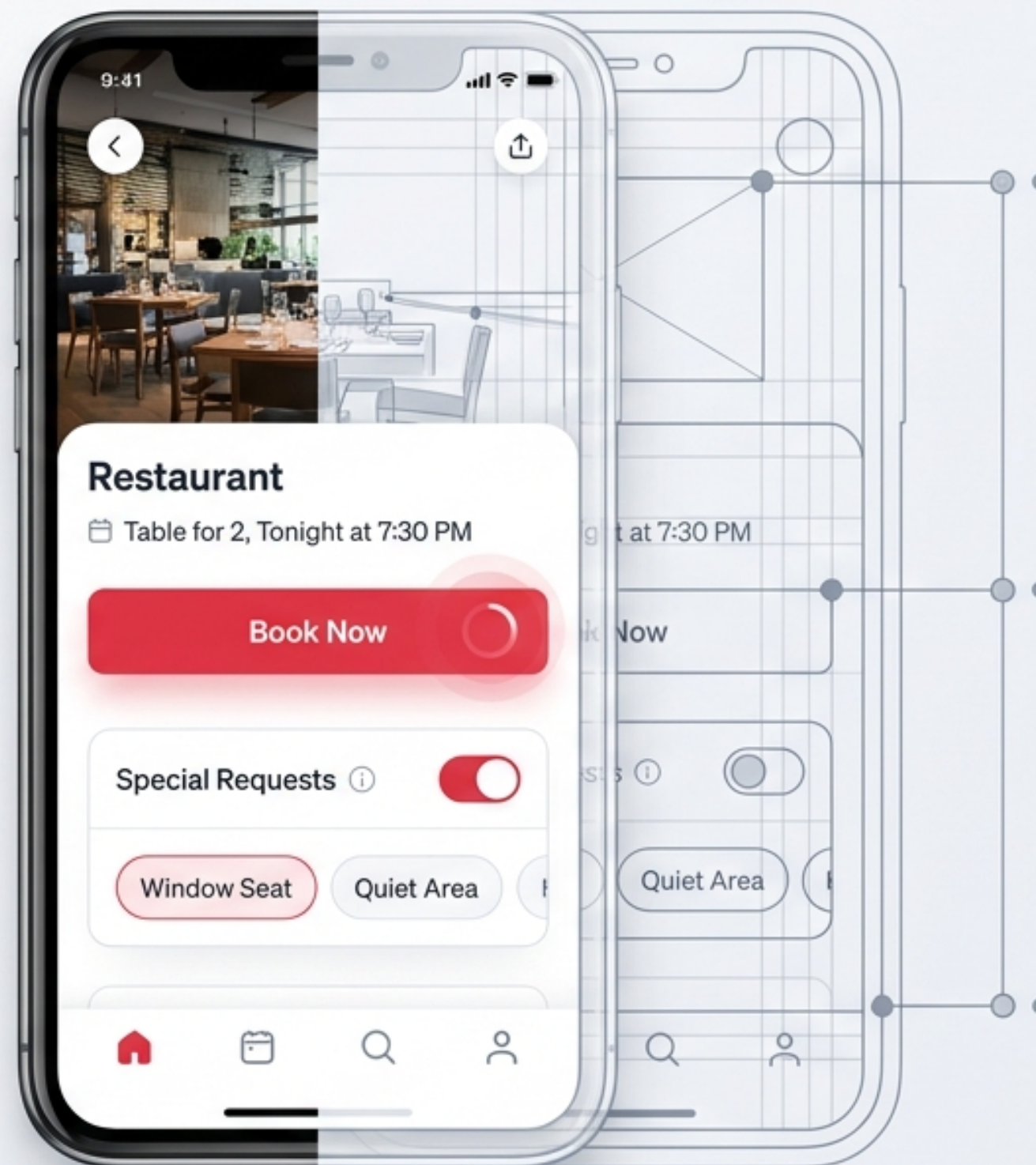


Frictionless Dining

A Zomato Dine-in UX Case Study optimizing the reservation funnel for speed, clarity, and conversion.



Executive Summary



The Problem

High cognitive load and system friction in the reservation process were leading to user drop-offs.

140s

Average booking time in baseline.



The Solution

An alternative, streamlined UI booking path minimizing steps and removing redundant decisions.

36%

Reduction in booking time.



The Impact

Drastic improvements in task success mapping directly to projected revenue growth.

3037%

Projected ROI

Listening to the Users



Kumar Yash

22

Post-Grad

Focus: Performance & Value



The dine-in page feels so glitchy that I avoid it unless I necessarily have to use it.

📌 Needs: Smooth scrolling, student discounts, crowd demographics.



Navdeep

21

Undergrad

Focus: Accuracy & Vibe



It was so crowded that I couldn't have a proper conversation... ruins the vibe sometimes.

📍 Needs: Real-time wait times, accurate open/close status, map visibility.



Tanvi

27

Returning Student

Focus: Decision Efficiency



Sometimes I spend more time deciding where to eat than actually eating.

📌 Needs: Advanced dietary filtering, reduced overwhelming options.

Diagnosing the Friction

Symptom: Glitchy UI, slow image loading, unresponsive scrolling.

Impact: Drives users away from the feature entirely.



System Friction



Information Gaps

Symptom: Outdated listings, obscured names on maps, lack of real-time crowd data.

Impact: Unpredictable physical dining experiences.



Decision Fatigue

Symptom: Overwhelming volume of choices without contextual filters.

Symptom: Overwhelming volume of choices without adequate contextual filters.

Impact: Increased time-on-task just to select a venue.

The Target Persona



Abhinav Verma

Age 22

CS Undergrad

A tech-savvy extrovert who balances a tight budget with an active social life. Uses restaurants for both social gatherings and earnest meetings.

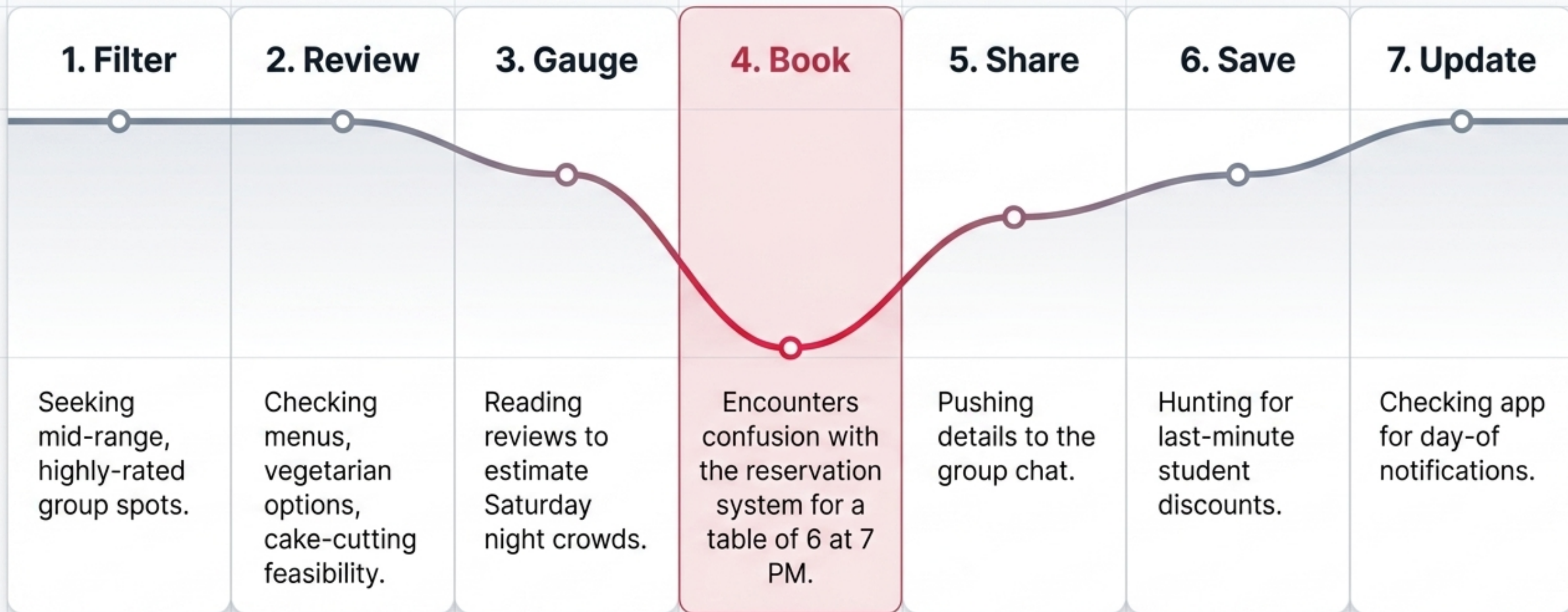
Goals

- ✓ Predict the 'vibe' of a place.
- ✓ Cater to group dietary needs.
- ✓ Discover affordable options.

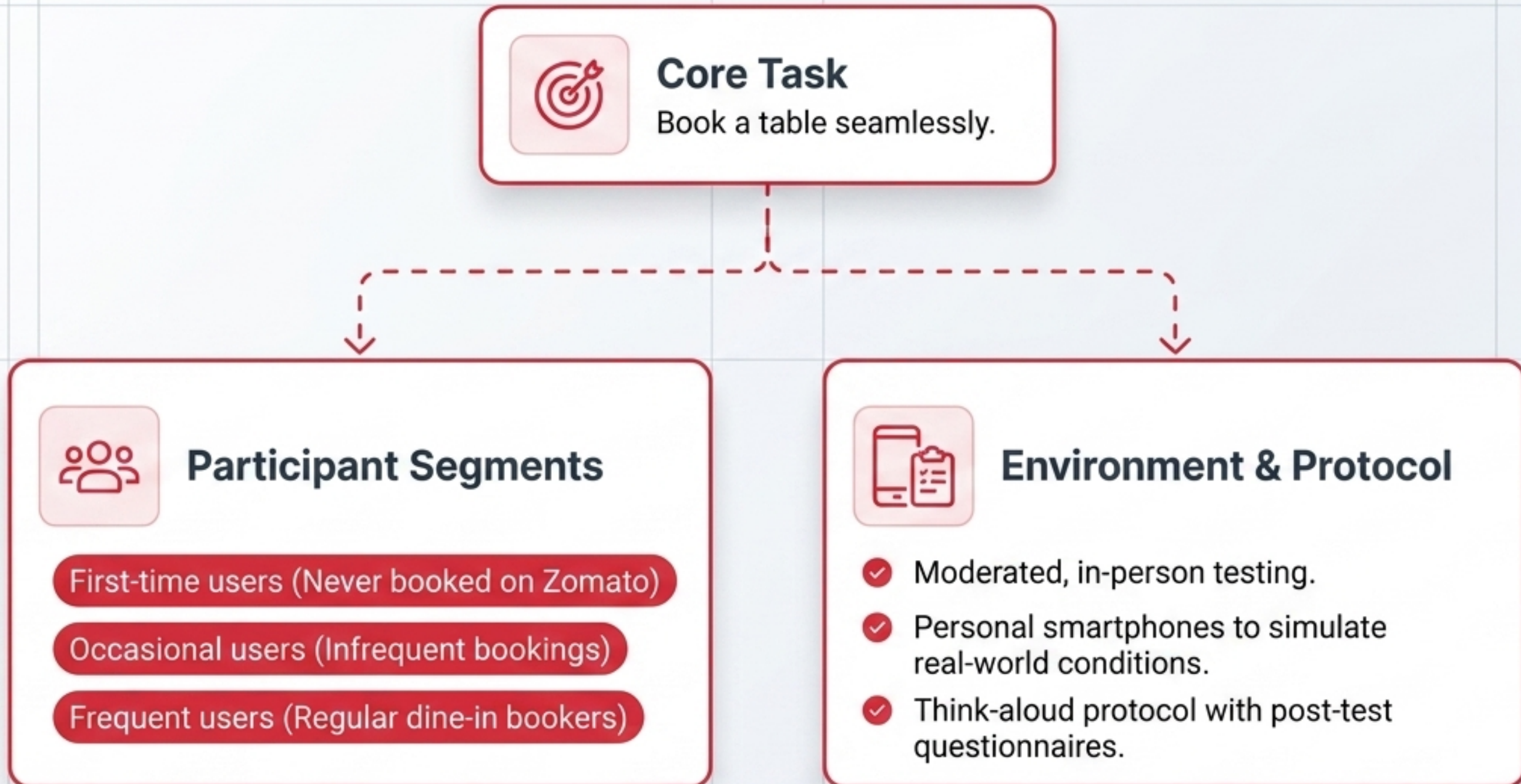
Pain Points

- ✗ Overwhelming options paralyze quick decisions.
- ✗ Lack of real-time info on crowd magnitude.
- ✗ Absence of student-specific deals.

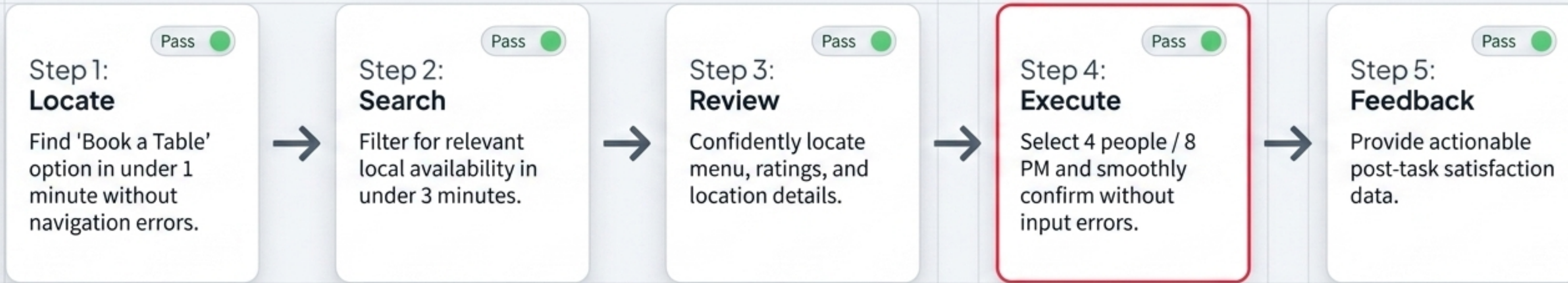
The Group Dinner Journey



Evaluative Strategy & Test Setup



The Booking Funnel Architecture

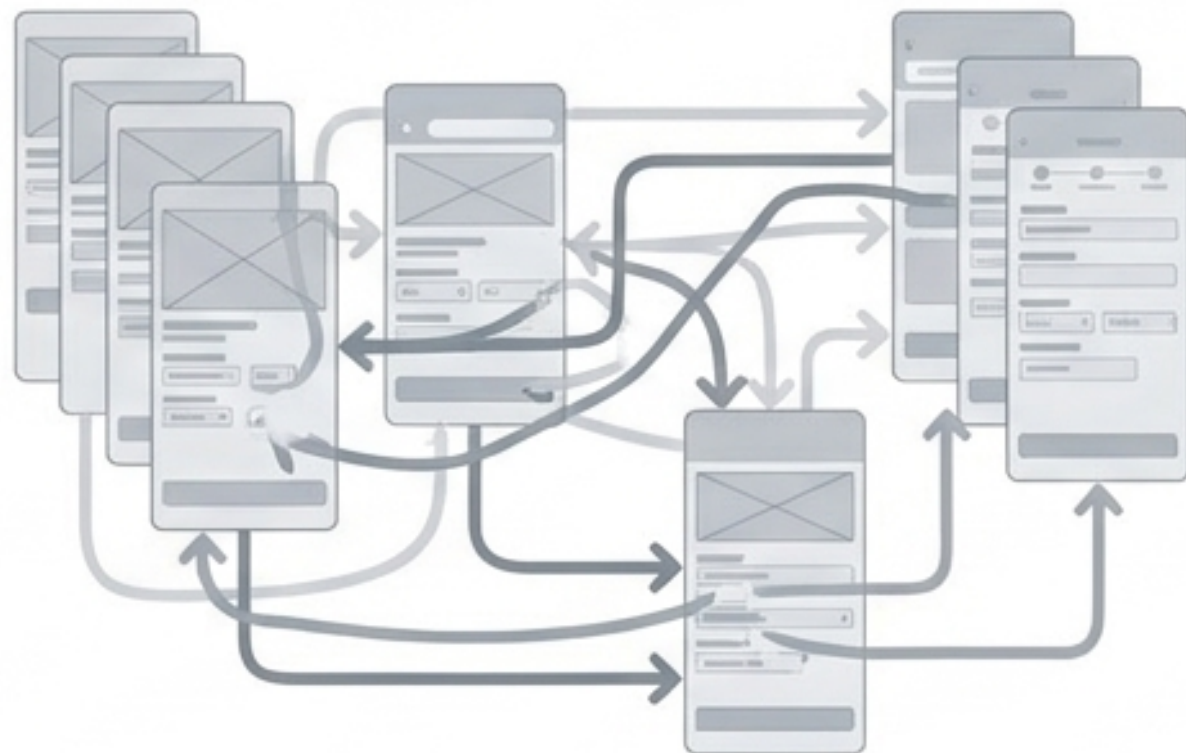


Original Path vs. The Intervention

The baseline app was tested directly against an alternative Figma UI kit design optimized to reduce steps and clarify inputs during the reservation funnel.

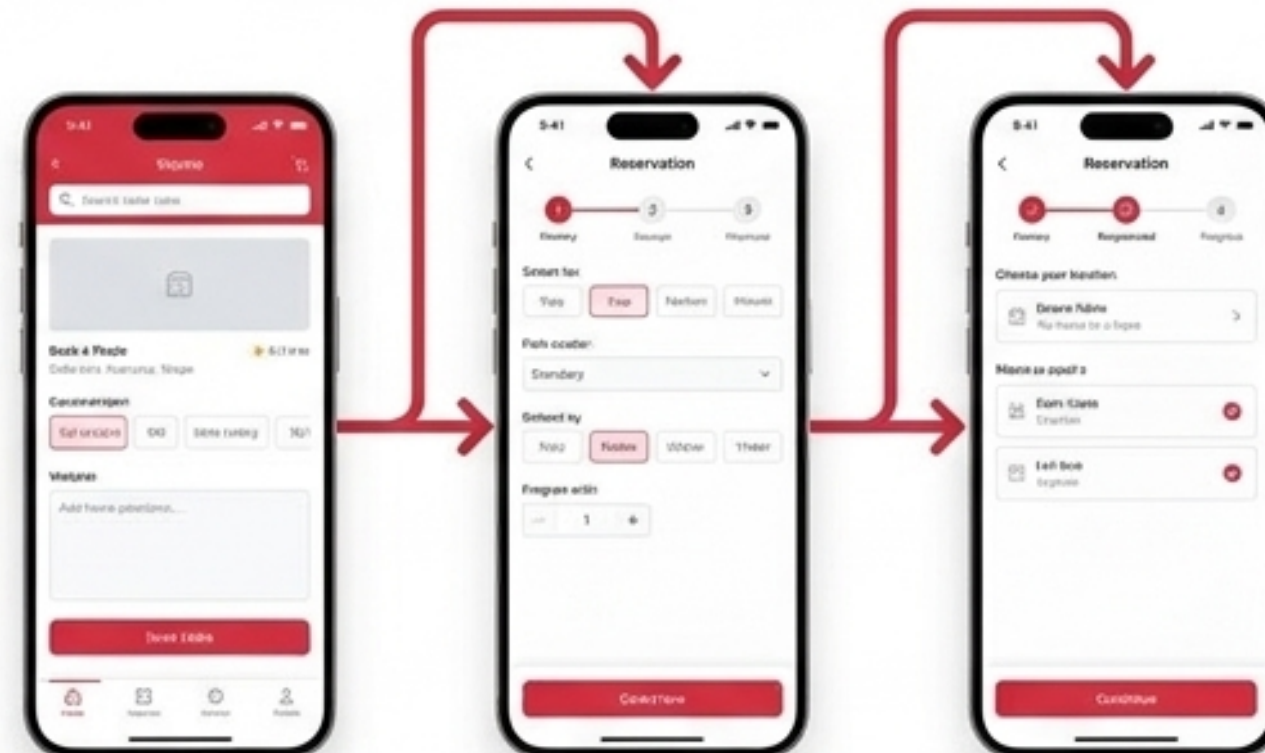
Original Path

High Cognitive Load



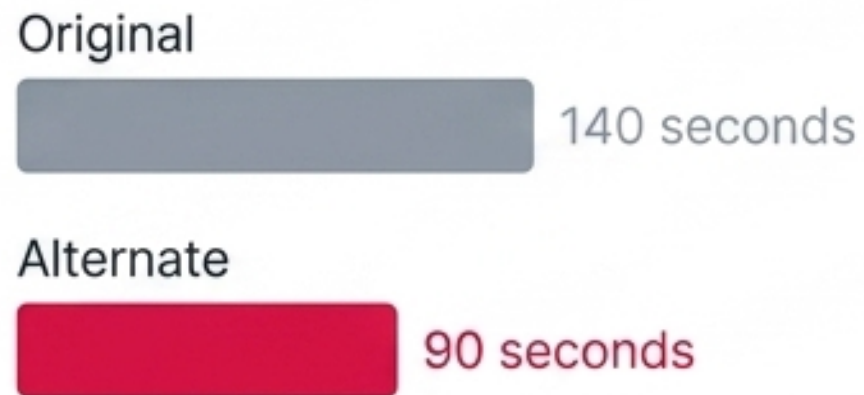
Alternate Path

Streamlined Architecture



Quantitative Usability Metrics

Task Completion Time



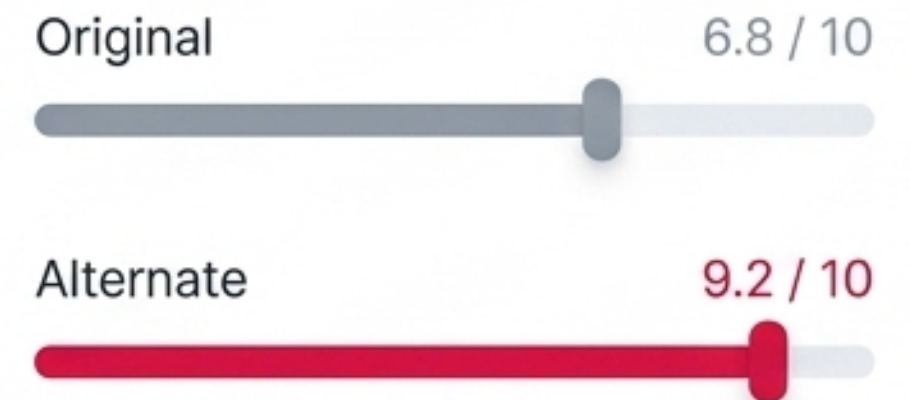
↓ 36% Faster

Task Success Rate



↑ +20% Improvement

User Satisfaction



↑ +2.4 Score Jump

Qualitative Insights & Next Iteration

"The process felt faster and easier."

"I didn't have to go through multiple unnecessary steps."

Reservation Confirmation

Complete your reservation

Reservation Details

Search rooms

Date: Jun 18, 2023

Time: 12:00 PM

Guests: 4

Confirmation

Actionable Iteration Insight

While the flow improved, users requested stronger visual cues during the final reservation confirmation stage to increase system confidence.

Update Planned

Calculating Business Impact



Conversion Boost: 25%



+1,250
daily bookings



Daily Revenue Gain

1,250 bookings × ₹100/table = +₹1.25 Lakhs/day



Total Investment

₹15 Lakhs (₹10L Design + ₹5L Testing)



Annual Gross Gain: ₹4.56 Cr

3037%

Net ROI

Value Beyond the Numbers



Brand Loyalty

Faster, frictionless experiences directly drive positive word-of-mouth and recurring usage habits.



Competitive Edge

Simplifying the reservation funnel entrenches Zomato as the default dine-in app over regional competitors.



Upsell Ecosystem

Highly engaged users are primed to explore premium features like priority reservations and restaurant-specific discounts.

Deployment Recommendation

The alternate path is a proven success.
A **36% reduction** in booking time yields a
projected **₹4.56 Cr** annual **opportunity**.

Next Step: Phased deployment of the optimized Figma UI path to capitalize on the **3037% ROI**, solidify market dominance, and continually refine visual confirmation cues based on user feedback.

Deploy Now →